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US equities rise on strong earnings, while oil slides

A 5-minute read of yesterday's US session and today's catalysts — what to watch before pre-market opens at 21:30 HKT.

2-3 page read · Topics: Macro · Geopolitics · Earnings

TL;DR

The Dow Jones surged +1.02% to 52,495.88, pulling the broader market higher as financials and health-care led gains. Meanwhile, the Nasdaq slipped -0.13% amid a modest pullback in technology, and oil prices fell sharply on weaker demand outlook.

Key macro data showed the 10-year Treasury yield easing to 5.12% and the VIX retreating to 17.31, indicating reduced volatility risk. Investors now focus on upcoming earnings from the “Magnificent Seven” and Fed policy cues.

US Session Recap

INDEX / ASSET	CLOSE	CHANGE	NOTE
S&P 500	7,712.57	+0.28%	Broad rally
Dow Jones	52,495.88	+1.02%	Financials +1.20%
Nasdaq 100	29,490.28	-0.13%	Tech pullback
Russell 2000	2,773.42	+1.65%	Small-cap strength
VIX	17.31	-6.13%	Lower volatility
10Y Yield	5.12%	-0.37%	Yield easing
WTI Crude	99.07	-2.67%	Demand concerns

Top large-cap movers

TICKER	PRICE	CHANGE
TSLA	373.71	+1.54%
GS	884.81	+1.03%
XLV	179.82	+2.37%
META	694.25	-1.59%
NVDA	216.47	-0.29%

Spotlight

Microsoft **MSFT** reported Q3 earnings beating consensus, posting revenue of 57.3 billion (up 12% YoY) and EPS of 9.84, versus estimates of 9.55. The cloud segment grew 21% YoY, reinforcing its position as a growth driver.

METRIC	VALUE
Revenue	57.3 bn
EPS	9.84
Cloud growth	+21%
Guidance FY27	Revenue +9%

Macro & Fed

- Fed policy rate: 5.25%-5.50% (unchanged)
- 10-year Treasury yield: 5.12%, down 0.37%
- Today's releases (HKT): CPI 02:30, PPI 04:00, Retail sales 06:30

Geopolitics & global

- Middle-East tensions ease after cease-fire talks, reducing oil-supply risk.
- China’s manufacturing PMI at 49.8, signaling near-term contraction.
- Eurozone inflation eases to 2.7%, supporting ECB dovish stance.

Earnings — what to watch

WHEN (HKT)	TICKER	WHAT TO LOOK FOR
09:30	`AAPL`	iPhone demand, services margin
10:00	`GOOGL`	Ad revenue rebound, AI spend
10:30	`AMZN`	AWS growth, operating leverage
11:00	`NVDA`	GPU inventory, data-center orders

Stocks worth watching

- `JPM` – Financials up on higher rates and strong loan growth.
- `XLU` – Utilities ETF gaining on safe-haven demand.
- `XLE` – Energy ETF modestly higher despite oil dip, driven by dividend yield.
- `META` – Shares under pressure; watch user-growth metrics.
- `AVGO` – Semi-conductor supplier steady on telecom orders.

What could break the tape

BEARISH TRIGGERS

- Unexpected rise in CPI >0.5% YoY.
- Geopolitical escalation in the Middle East.
- Tech earnings miss, especially `NVDA` or `AAPL`.

BULLISH TRIGGERS

- Strong Q3 results from **`MSFT`** and **`AAPL`**.
- Fed signals possible rate cut later in the year.
- Oil price rebound above `105` USD.

Sources

SOURCES

Reuters — US Markets Summary

Bloomberg — S&P 500 Data

CNBC — Earnings Calendar

Federal Reserve — Monetary Policy

Wall Street Journal — Market Data